

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 7

New Case: Aryan – Imagery Rescripting & Review

Full Detailed – More Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Aryan (32 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	7 of 18–20	Focus:	Imagery Rescripting + Review

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client had mixed results with Worry Postponement and behavioral activation. He continues to express frustration about slow progress. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought remains stable around 55%. Today's plan: Review homework, introduce **Imagery Rescripting** for the core belief (deeper emotional work), continue cognitive restructuring, and assign integrated homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Aryan. How has your week been? Let's review the homework.

Client: It was average. Worry Postponement helped on some days. I did two small activities again. The time-limit experiment was still difficult. I'm still feeling like things are moving very slowly. I don't know if this is really working.

Therapist: Thank you for being honest. These feelings of frustration and doubt are very common at this stage. Change often feels slow in the beginning, especially with core beliefs. Today we can try a different approach that works more on the emotional side of the belief.

INTRODUCING IMAGERY RESCRIPTING

Therapist: Since we've been working on the belief "I have to be perfect or they will start doubting me," and it seems deeply rooted, I'd like to introduce a technique called **Imagery Rescripting**. It uses mental imagery to revisit early memories that fuel the belief and change the emotional meaning. It can be powerful for beliefs that feel very old and strong. We'll go slowly and you'll stay in control the whole time. Would you like to try?

Client: I'm not sure... It sounds intense. What if it makes me feel worse?

Therapist: That's a very valid concern. We'll only do a short, gentle version and stop anytime you want. Many people find it helpful, but we can go at your pace. If it doesn't feel right, we can stop and try something else.

Client: Okay... I'll try, but please go slowly.

(Therapist guides a brief, gentle imagery rescripting exercise based on a childhood memory of feeling pressure to perform perfectly. Client imagines a more compassionate adult version of himself intervening. The exercise is kept short and contained. Client becomes slightly emotional but manages well.)

Therapist: How are you feeling after that?

Client: It was emotional... but I felt like I could give that younger version of me permission to not be perfect. It made the new belief feel a bit more real.

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: After the imagery exercise, how much do you believe the old thought "I have to be perfect or they will start doubting me" right now?

Client: It dropped to about 45% during the exercise. I still feel it, but it feels a bit lighter.

Therapist: That's a meaningful shift. Imagery work often helps the balanced thought feel more emotionally true, not just logically true. We can build on this gradually.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Postponement practice
2. Continue scheduling 2–3 small activities per week
3. Continue the time-limit experiment with small tasks
4. Write a short compassionate note from your "adult self" to your younger self about not needing to be perfect (we can review it next session)

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your honest progress, introduced Imagery Rescripting, and saw a meaningful shift in how the belief felt during the exercise. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: It was emotional, but I think it helped a bit. I'm still not sure how much it will change overall though.

Therapist: That's completely fair. These deeper techniques often take time and repetition to show full effect. Any questions?

Client: No.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client had mixed results with previous techniques — realistic.
- Imagery Rescripting introduced; client was initially hesitant but participated and found it meaningful.
- Belief in old thought dropped from ~55% to 45% during the imagery exercise — meaningful emotional shift.
- Client continues to express realistic doubt about overall progress.
- Next session: Review compassionate note, continue imagery work if helpful, deepen behavioral activation, continue cognitive restructuring.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.